

English

Year 5

Cambridge Primary
Student Manual



Imprint

Prime Books

English • Year 5 • Student Manual

For Year 5 English learners in international primary classrooms.

This book is an original Prime Books teaching manual. Skill coverage follows a full Year 5 English sequence for international primary classrooms; all continuous texts, activities and wording are original.

British English spelling and punctuation are used throughout.

Editorial Board: Pedagogical Academic Group • Content Creation Team

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Welcome to Year 5 English

Hello!

This year you will become a stronger reader, writer, speaker and listener. You will meet fables and timeless tales, explore space through information texts, play with poetry, follow instructions, and write stories of your own.

Every unit gives you:

- something interesting to read (written for this book);
- clear language rules explained in simple steps;
- vocabulary you can actually use;
- writing that is modelled first, then practised;
- speaking and listening that feels real, not robotic.

Mistakes are part of learning. Read carefully, talk about ideas, and write a little better each week.

You've got this!

How this book works with your lessons

Use this manual in class and at home. Your teacher may also use a workbook for extra practice. Read the model texts more than once. Talk before you write. Tick the I can... boxes only when they are true for you.

Units 1 to 6 cover the main Stage 5 English skills: stories and fables, information and space writing, poetry, classic tales, instructions, and narrative poems.

How we learn in this book

You will see the same friendly signposts in every unit. They help you know what to do next.

We are going to...

The aims for the unit, written in pupil-friendly language.

Getting ready

A short chat or question so you use what you already know.

Read with me

An original model text. Read it more than once.

Talk about it

Speaking and listening: partners, groups, or the whole class.

Language focus

Grammar and sentence craft, with clear examples.

Word bank

Useful words from the unit, used in real sentences.

Write step by step

A writing model broken into small stages.

I can...

Self-check statements. Tick only what is true for you.

Mini project

A short creative task that uses the unit skills.

Practice pages and extra write-in tasks may appear in a companion workbook later.

This Student Manual is your teaching and learning guide.

Contents

Six units • reading, writing, speaking, listening, language and vocabulary

Unit 1 • Lessons in stories

Fables and timeless tales • message, character, retell

Unit 2 • Exploring space

Information texts, biography and recount • clear facts

Unit 3 • Reflections

Poetry • similes, metaphors, personification, haiku

Unit 4 • Timeless tales

Classic stories and drama • character and voice

Unit 5 • Tell me how

Instructions and explanations • purpose and clarity

Unit 6 • A different type of story

Narrative poetry • rhyme, mood and performance

Back of the book: Spelling toolkit • Key terms • Answers guidance

Unit 1

Lessons in stories

Stories can teach without shouting. Fables and traditional tales hide clever messages inside animals, tricks and journeys. In this unit you become a story detective: you find the message, study the characters, and rewrite endings with confidence.

We are going to...

- spot the features of a fable and a traditional tale;
- talk about stereotypes and fairer ways to describe characters;
- use modal verbs (can, could, should, must) carefully;
- punctuate simple dialogue;
- write a short fable fact file and a clear opinion paragraph;
- retell a tale in a new form (cartoon strip or dialogue).

Getting ready

Talk with a partner:

- Have you ever heard two different versions of the same story?
- What makes a story feel like a fable?
- Why might a writer choose animals as characters?

Read with me • The Clever Sparrow (original fable)



In a dusty courtyard lived a sparrow no bigger than a child's fist. The bigger birds laughed. "You are too small to matter," croaked a crow. The sparrow only tilted her head.

One hot afternoon the water pot cracked. The big birds flapped and shouted. The sparrow fetched pebble after pebble and dropped them into the pot. Slowly the water rose. Everyone drank.

That evening the crow muttered, "Size is not the same as sense." The sparrow said nothing. She was already planning where to nest when the rains came.

Message: Small helpers can solve big problems when they stay calm and keep working.

Talk about it

- Who changes in the story, and how do you know?
- Is the crow's first idea about the sparrow fair? Why or why not?
- Retell the ending from the crow's point of view in three sentences.

Language focus • Modal verbs and dialogue

Modal verbs show possibility, ability or advice: can, could, may, might, must, should, will, would.

Example: The sparrow could carry only one pebble at a time. She still would not give up.

Dialogue punctuation: new speaker, new line. Speech marks around the spoken words. A comma, question mark or exclamation mark sits inside the speech marks when a reporting clause follows.

Example: "You are too small to matter," croaked a crow.

Word bank

- fable — a short story that teaches a message, often with animal characters;
- stereotype — a fixed idea about a group that is too simple to be fair;
- proverb — a short well-known saying that shares advice;
- moral — the lesson a reader can take from a story;
- alliteration — repeated starting sounds (pebble after pebble).

Write step by step • Fable fact file

Create a one-page fact file for The Clever Sparrow (or a fable you invent). Include:

- Title and setting;
- Main characters (two or three traits each — avoid unfair stereotypes);
- Problem and solution;
- Message in one clear sentence;
- One proverb that matches the message (you may invent a gentle one).

Challenge: add a four-panel cartoon strip that retells the ending without copying the full text.

Speaking & listening

In pairs, perform a 60-second dialogue between the sparrow and the crow after the pot is fixed. Use at least two modal verbs and correct speech punctuation when you write your script first.

I can...

- ☐ explain what a fable is and give an example from this unit;
- ☐ use modal verbs to talk about ability and advice;
- ☐ punctuate a short dialogue correctly;

- ☐ write a fact file with a clear message;
- ☐ retell a story ending from another character's view.

Mini project

Collect three short messages from stories you know (home, library or class). Sort them into Kindness · Clever thinking · Fairness. Present one message to the class without spoiling the whole plot.

Unit 2

Exploring space

Space is not only rockets. It is careful science writing, brave people, and timelines that help us see change. You will read information texts and practise writing that stays clear, ordered and true.

We are going to...

- use information texts, recounts and short biographies;
- order events with adverbials of time;
- build simple and compound sentences on purpose;
- plan a weekly diary and a short blog entry;
- prepare interview questions and write a mini biography;
- choose precise space vocabulary and synonyms.

Getting ready

- What is the difference between a fact and an opinion about space?
- Would you rather research the Moon or write a diary as an astronaut? Why?

Read with me • A day on the station (original recount extract)



At 06:30 UTC the crew woke to a soft beep, not a cockerel. Breakfast floated in sealed packs. By mid-morning we checked the water recycler. In the afternoon we filmed a

science lesson for schools. Before sleep we wrote logs: what worked, what needed fixing, and one thing that still amazed us — the thin blue line of Earth's atmosphere.

Talk about it

- Which time phrases help you follow the day?
- Which details are facts you could check?
- What question would you ask this astronaut in an interview?

Language focus • Simple and compound sentences • adverbials of time

A simple sentence has one main idea: The crew checked the water recycler.

A compound sentence joins two equal ideas with and, but or or: We filmed a lesson, and then we wrote our logs.

Adverbials of time answer when: at 06:30, by mid-morning, before sleep, later that evening.

Write step by step

- Make a five-event timeline of an imaginary space day.
- Turn the timeline into a short recount (120–150 words) using at least four time adverbials.
- Write five interview questions for a real or invented astronaut (open questions, not only yes/no).

I can...

- ☐ tell fact from opinion in an information text;
- ☐ use time adverbials to order a recount;
- ☐ write simple and compound sentences on purpose;
- ☐ plan interview questions for a biography.

Unit 3

Reflections

Poems can hold a whole feeling in a few lines. You will read poetry carefully, name figurative language, and write a haiku that earns its quiet power.

We are going to...

- read poems aloud with expression;
- identify similes, metaphors and personification;
- compare images across short poems;
- plan, write and polish a haiku;
- use comparisons without overloading a line.

Read with me • Harbour Light (original poem)



The lighthouse wears a coat of salt.

Its eye blinks gold across the ink-black tide.

Small boats, like moths, lean toward the glow.

Night listens. Waves applaud. The sky holds its breath.

Talk about it

- Find one simile and one example of personification.

- What mood does the poem create, and which word choices build it?
- Change one image and explain how the mood shifts.

Language focus • Figurative language

Simile: a comparison using like or as — boats, like moths.

Metaphor: a comparison that says one thing is another — the lighthouse's eye.

Personification: giving human actions to non-human things — Night listens.

Write step by step • Haiku

A haiku is short and sharp. Aim for a clear moment in nature or city life. Count syllables carefully (a common pattern is 5–7–5 in English classroom practice). Include one strong image and one quiet surprise.

I can...

- ☐ name simile, metaphor and personification in a poem;
- ☐ read a short poem aloud with expression;
- ☐ write and edit a haiku with a clear image.

Unit 4

Timeless tales

Some stories travel across years and cultures. You will study how classic tales and plays show character, and you will try a splash of screenplay and a careful retell.

We are going to...

- read a blurb, a story opening and a short play-style scene (original);
- build a character profile with evidence;
- use direct and indirect speech accurately;
- spot formal Standard English versus chatty dialogue;
- write a short screenplay beat and a fair retell.

Read with me • Door at the End of the Lane (original opening)



Nobody in Millbridge used the green door. It stood at the end of Willow Lane, half-hidden by ivy. On Tuesday, Lila stopped. "If no one opens it," she whispered, "how do we know it is locked?"

Her brother, Max, folded his arms. "Because Mum said so." Lila, however, had already counted the ivy leaves. There were seventeen. She liked odd numbers. She liked questions more.

Talk about it

- What do we learn about Lila from what she says and does?
- How is Max different? Use evidence.
- Is Mum's rule a fact we can trust, or something the characters believe?

Language focus • Direct and indirect speech • quantifiers

Direct speech quotes the exact words: "Because Mum said so."

Indirect speech reports meaning: Max said that Mum had told them not to open the door.

Quantifiers tell us how many or how much: nobody, seventeen, more, some, every.

Write step by step

- Character profile for Lila or Max: traits + evidence from the text.
- Rewrite Max's spoken line as indirect speech.
- Write a five-line screenplay beat (character names in capitals, short action lines) that starts when the door clicks.

I can...

- ☐ support a character trait with a quotation or clear paraphrase;
- ☐ change direct speech into indirect speech;
- ☐ write a short screenplay-style beat with clear speakers.

Unit 5

Tell me how

Instructions and explanations keep people safe and ideas clear. You will read non-fiction that tells how and why, then write your own leaflet that a real Year 5 pupil could follow.

We are going to...

- spot the difference between instructions and explanations;
- use imperative verbs and clear order words;
- write topic sentences and short summaries;
- design a leaflet with purpose and audience in mind;
- listen to and give oral instructions accurately.

Read with me • How to pack a field-trip bag (original instructions)



You will need: a sturdy backpack, a labelled water bottle, a sun hat, a notebook, a pencil, and a small snack in a sealed box.

1. Check the weather note from your teacher.
2. Place the water bottle in the side pocket so it stays upright.
3. Put the notebook and pencil in the front zip so you can reach them quickly.

4. Add your snack last, above soft items, so nothing crushes it.
5. Weigh the bag with two hands. If it feels too heavy, remove one non-essential item and ask an adult.

Talk about it

- Which verbs tell the reader to do something?
- Why does order matter in these steps?
- How would you change the text for a rainy-day trip?

Language focus • Purpose, connectives and complex sentences

Instructions often use imperatives: Check, Place, Add.

Explanations answer why: We put the bottle upright so it does not leak.

Connectives link ideas: first, then, after that, because, so that, if.

Complex sentence example: If the bag feels too heavy, remove one item before you leave.

Write step by step

- Choose a safe classroom task (sharpening a pencil correctly, logging into a shared tablet, lining up for PE).
- Write numbered instructions (5–7 steps) with clear imperatives.
- Add a short explanation box: Why this keeps us safe or organised.
- Turn your work into a simple leaflet with a title, materials list and warning note.

I can...

- ☐ tell instructions from explanations;
- ☐ use imperatives and order words clearly;
- ☐ write a short leaflet for a real audience;
- ☐ give and follow spoken instructions accurately.

Unit 6

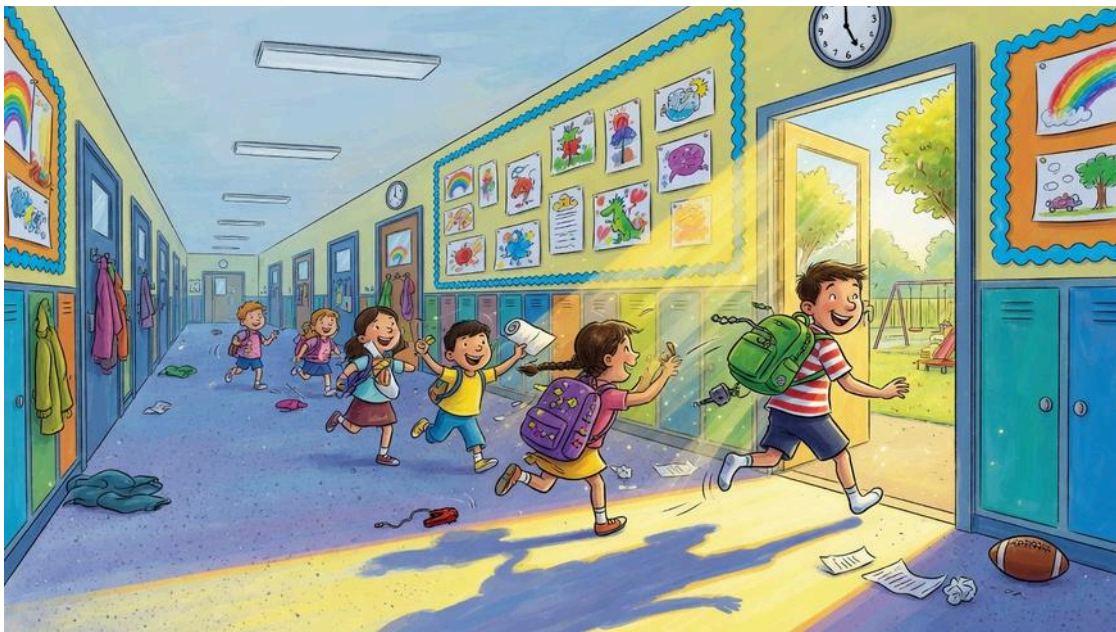
A different type of story

Narrative poems tell stories with rhythm, sound and feeling. You will compare poems, perform with control, and write a narrative poem from a clear frame.

We are going to...

- identify story elements inside a poem;
- name types of rhyme and simple sound patterns;
- compare two short narrative poems;
- perform a poem in a group with shared timing;
- write a narrative poem using a planning frame.

Read with me • The Last Bell (original narrative poem extract)



The corridor held its breath at three.

Bags thumped like soft green thunder.

*Maya counted tiles — one, two, free —
then spilled into sunlight, full of wonder.*

*Behind her, chalk dust floated slow,
a silver snow that teachers know.*

Talk about it

- What story event happens in these lines?
- Where do you hear rhyme? Which words chime?
- How does the poem show excitement without saying the word excited?

Language focus • Rhyme, rhythm and figures of speech

End rhyme: three / free; slow / know.

Alliteration: soft... spilled... sunlight.

Simile: Bags thumped like soft green thunder.

Narrative poetry still needs character, setting and a moment of change.

Write step by step • Narrative poem frame

- Choose a small real moment (first day, lost key, rainy goal, bus wave).
- Plan: character • place • problem • turning point • final image.
- Write 8–12 lines. Use at least one simile or metaphor and one clear rhyme pair.
- Perform in a group of three: one reads, one echoes key lines, one adds a still image (freeze-frame).

I can...

- ☐ find story elements in a narrative poem;
- ☐ talk about rhyme and sound effects with examples;
- ☐ write a short narrative poem from a plan;
- ☐ perform a poem with shared group timing.

Spelling toolkit

Spelling is a tool, not a trap. Use these habits in every unit:

- Say the word slowly in syllables.
- Underline the tricky part.
- Write it three times in a real sentence, not only in a list.
- Keep a personal list of words you often miss.
- Proofread once for meaning and once for spelling.

Homophones to watch this year include: their / there / they're • your / you're • its / it's • to / too / two.

Key terms (starter glossary)

alliteration — repeating starting sounds in nearby words

biography — a text about a real person's life

compound sentence — two complete ideas joined by and, but or or

dialogue — spoken words between characters

fable — a short tale that teaches a message

imperative — a verb form that gives an instruction

metaphor — a comparison that says one thing is another

modal verb — a helping verb that shows possibility, ability or advice

personification — giving human actions to non-human things

simile — a comparison using like or as

stereotype — an unfair fixed idea about a group

topic sentence — the sentence that states the main idea of a paragraph

PRIME BOOKS

English

Year 5 · Cambridge Primary · Student Manual

Welcome to Year 5 English.

Six units of reading, writing, speaking and listening, each built around a whole text. Read like a writer, write like a reader, and say exactly what you mean.

INSIDE THIS BOOK

- Six units, six whole texts
- Reading, writing, speaking and listening together
- Vocabulary met, used and kept
- A piece of writing to be proud of in every unit
- Answers guidance for the teacher, not printed answers to copy

Prime Books · English

Ages 9–10 · Upper Primary

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